

Handout 2.4: SMART Goal Builder

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

Directions: A wish is something you want. A goal is a wish with a number and a date on it. Today you learn the five-letter test, fix five goals that fail it, and write two of your own that pass.

Word bank in other languages

[Check with a native speaker before printing.]

English	Turkish	Portuguese	Spanish
goal	hedef	meta (objetivo)	meta (objetivo)
specific	belirli (net)	específico	específico
measure	ölçmek	medir	medir
deadline	son tarih	prazo	fecha límite
stretch goal	büyük hedef (uzun vadeli)	meta ambiciosa	meta ambiciosa

Part 1: The five letters, and SMART vs stretch

Letter	Stands for	In my words	The question to ask
S	Specific		What exactly will I do?
M	Measurable		What number will I count?
A	Achievable		Can I actually do this with what I have?
R	Relevant		Which of my values does this connect to?
T	Time-bound		By what date?

A **SMART goal** is: _____

A **stretch goal** is: _____

Rule: a stretch goal is not wrong. It just cannot be your only goal. Every stretch goal needs a SMART goal under it.

Part 2: Sort the six

Your teacher shows six goals. Write S for SMART, ST for stretch, or V for vague.

#	Goal	S, ST, or V
1	I will play in the NBA.	
2	I will raise my math quiz average from 72 to 80 by the end of the marking period by doing the practice set every night.	
3	I want to be healthier.	
4	I will save \$60 by December 1 by putting \$5 a week from my allowance in the jar.	
5	I will own my own restaurant.	
6	I will try harder in school.	

Part 3: Fix the vague goal

Each goal below is missing some letters. Write the missing letters, then rewrite it as a SMART goal. Use the frame if you want it: **I will [what] [how much] by [date] by [how].**

Fix at least three. Grade 6: two. Grade 8: all five.

#	Vague goal	Missing letters	My SMART rewrite
1	I want to get better at math.		
2	I want to be healthier.		
3	I want to save money.		
4	I want to read more.		
5	I want to be a better basketball player.		

Partner check: trade papers. For each rewrite, circle the number and the date. If either is missing, hand it back.

Part 4: My two SMART goals

Open your Lesson 2.1 sort sheet. You need your top three values for the R.

My school goal



I will _____ [what] _____ [how much] by _____
[date] by _____ [how].

S	M	A	R	T
Check:	Check:	Check:	Check:	Check:

The value it connects to, and how:

My outside-school goal (home, a sport, money, a skill, a friend, anything not for a class)

I will _____ [what] _____ [how much] by _____
[date] by _____ [how].

S	M	A	R	T
Check:	Check:	Check:	Check:	Check:

The value it connects to, and how:

Stretch in disguise? Is either of your two goals really a stretch goal (big, far away, not fully in your control)? Circle: School / Outside / Neither. If you circled one, write the SMART goal that goes under it:



Grade 8 stretch: Write a stretch goal for the career on your 3-2-1 card, then two SMART goals under it: one for this year and one for high school.

Stretch goal: _____

This year: _____

High school: _____

Exit card

My school SMART goal in one line. Circle the number and the date.



Keep this sheet in your FACS folder. Tomorrow one of these two goals gets a ladder.

Teacher key

Part 1. Accept any plain-words version. A SMART goal: the next step you can actually take, with a number and a date. A stretch goal: the big thing the steps climb toward; far away, and not fully in your control.

Part 2. 1 ST, 2 S, 3 V, 4 S, 5 ST, 6 V. Goal 6 is the argument: some students say “try harder” is achievable. Ask what number they would count. There is none, so it is V.

Part 3. Missing letters and one sample rewrite each. Accept any rewrite that has a specific action, a number, a date, and a realistic how.

#	Missing	Sample SMART rewrite
1	S, M, T (and how)	I will raise my math quiz average from 72 to 80 by the end of the marking period by doing the practice set every night.
2	S, M, T	I will drink water instead of soda at lunch every school day for four weeks, starting Monday, and keep a tally on my folder.
3	S, M, T	I will save \$60 by December 1 by putting \$5 a week from my allowance in the jar.
4	S, M, T	I will finish two books by December 20 by reading 20 minutes every night before bed.
5	S, M, T	I will make 7 out of 10 free throws by the end of the season by practicing 20 minutes after school three days a week.

A rewrite that says “I will read more books this year” is still vague; send it back for a number and a date.

Part 4. A “got it” goal has all five checks filled and a value named. The value link is the R, and it is where the goal becomes the student’s own. A goal with no value link is usually a goal a parent gave the student; do not mark it wrong, but ask about it. The outside-school goal is often a stretch goal (“get a puppy”); that is what the “stretch in disguise” box is for, and the SMART goal under it (“save \$15 a week for 10 weeks”) is the answer.



Scoring for daily work. Complete: Parts 1 to 4 done, two goals with all five checks and a value link. Partial: one goal complete, or goals without a number or date. Missing: no goals written.